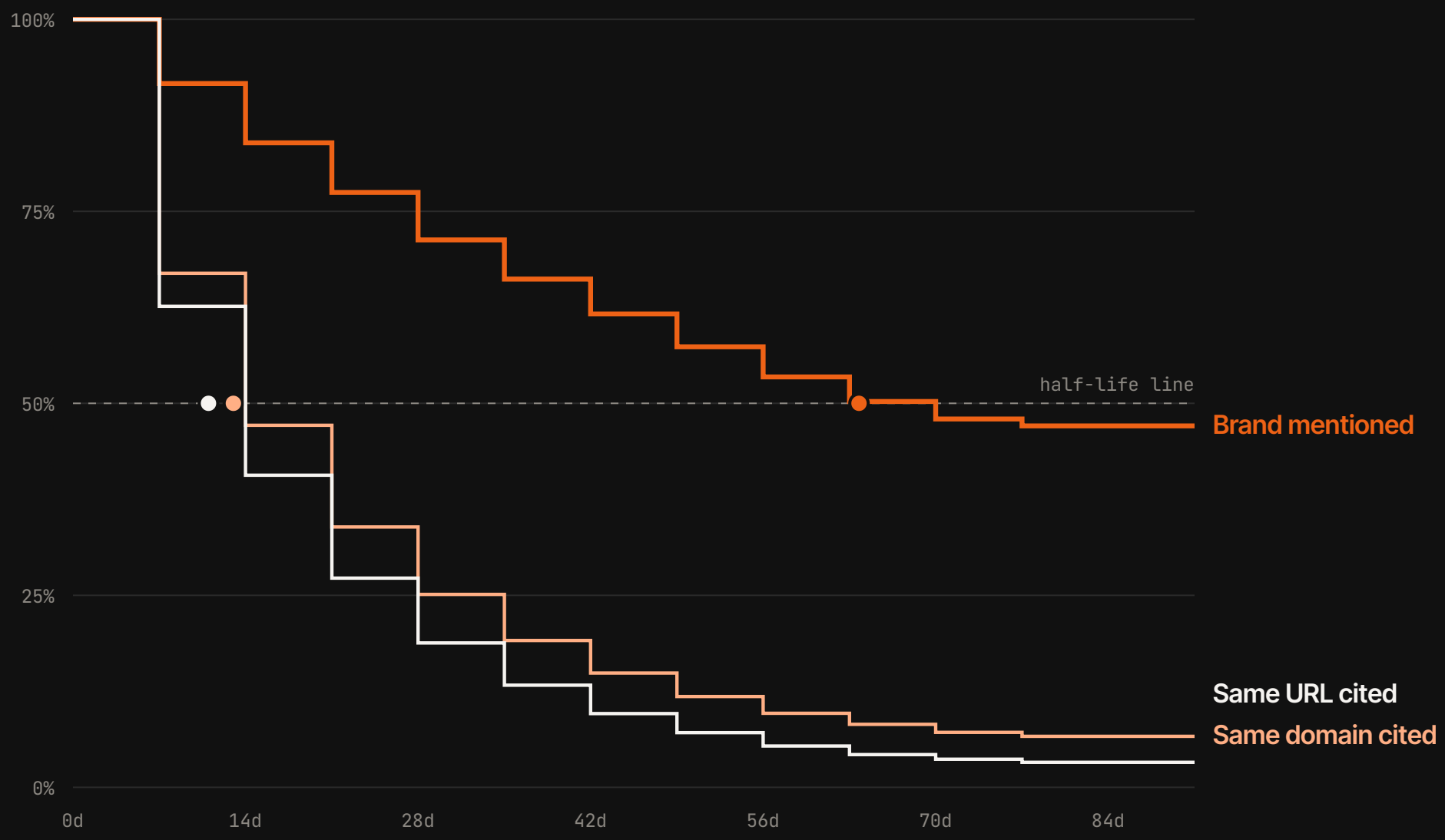
SIMULATED DATA · LAYOUT PREVIEW · NOT A FINDING

Slate

SLATE CITATION LAB · FINDING 01 · THE HALF-LIFE OF AN AI CITATION

Half of this week's AI citations are gone in 11 days.
Brand mentions last 5.8× longer.

SHARE STILL BEING CITED OR NAMED · BY DAYS SINCE FIRST APPEARANCE



11d
half-life of a cited URL

13d
half-life of a cited domain

64d
half-life of a brand mention

Shiyam Sunder · CEO, Slate · 40,281 AI answers · 14 weekly runs

swipe →

SIMULATED DATA · LAYOUT PREVIEW · NOT A FINDING

Slate

FINDING 02 · WEEKLY CHURN

42% of cited URLs are replaced every single week.

42%
of URLs cited one week are gone the next

38%
of domains

11%
of brands

STILL PRESENT AFTER…

	URL	domain	brand
after 1 week	63%	67%	92%
after 2 weeks	41%	47%	84%
after 4 weeks	19%	25%	71%
after 8 weeks	5%	10%	54%

→ A single weekly snapshot of "cited pages" is mostly noise. A brand-level trend is mostly signal.

SlateIndex · 40,281 AI answers · 14 weekly runs · 2026-08-10 to 2026-11-09

swipe →

SIMULATED DATA · LAYOUT PREVIEW · NOT A FINDING

Slate

FINDING 03 · BY SOURCE TYPE

Vendor site citations last longest. Community / UGC churns fastest.

URL CITATION HALF-LIFE BY SOURCE TYPE



Source type from the cited domain: vendor sites (tracked brands' own domains), review sites, community / UGC (Reddit, YouTube, LinkedIn, Quora…), and everything else.

→ If you want citations that stick, vendor site pages hold on 2.0× longer than community / UGC ones.

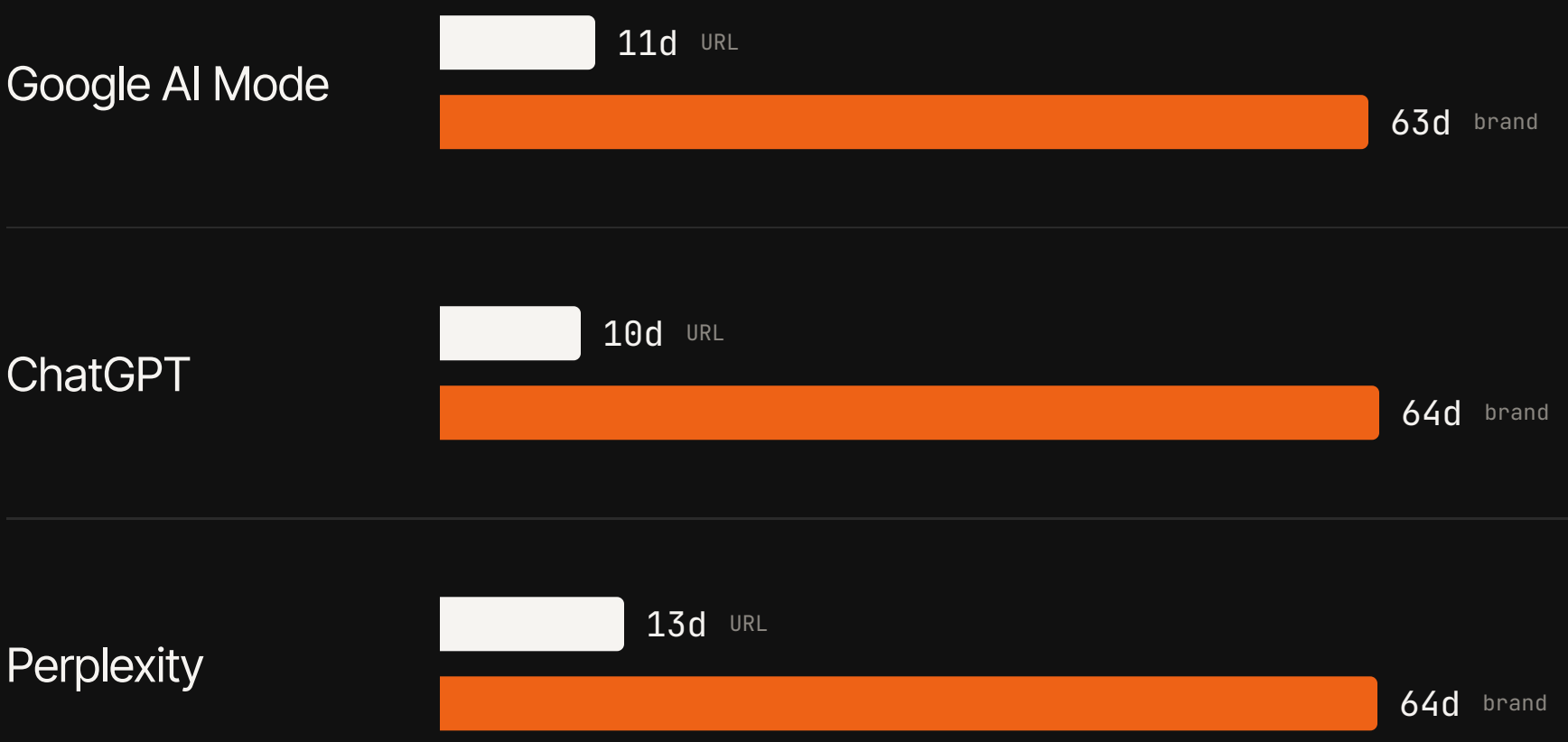
SIMULATED DATA · LAYOUT PREVIEW · NOT A FINDING

Slate

FINDING 04 · BY ENGINE

Every engine churns citations. None of them churn the shortlist.

HALF-LIFE IN DAYS · URL VS BRAND



→ The gap between citation churn and brand stability shows up on every engine.

SIMULATED DATA · LAYOUT PREVIEW · NOT A FINDING

Slate

METHOD

How we measured decay.

01

Same prompts, every week

990 fixed buyer prompts across 33 categories, run every Monday on Google AI Mode, ChatGPT, Perplexity. Answers collected from the consumer apps through data providers, not the APIs.

02

Track every item's spell

A spell is an unbroken run of weeks in which the same URL, domain or brand appears in the answer to the same prompt on the same engine.

03

Strict rules for "gone"

Gone = absent for 2 straight collected runs (one-week flickers don't count). A missing response is skipped, never counted as absent. Only spells that start after week 1 are used.

04

Kaplan-Meier survival

Half-life = median survival. Spells still alive at the last run are censored, not dropped. URL vs brand compared with a log-rank test.

→ 110,711 URL spells and 18,787 brand spells analysed.

SIMULATED DATA · LAYOUT PREVIEW · NOT A FINDING

LIMITS · WHAT IT MEANS

Measure the shortlist, not the snapshot.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

Report citations on a rolling 4-week window, never a single week.

Make brand mention rate the headline KPI; citations are the evidence underneath it.

Read a lost citation as normal turnover unless it stays gone for 2+ weeks.

LIMITS

14 weekly runs: spells longer than ~13 weeks are censored, so the longest half-lives are lower bounds.

One answer per prompt per engine per week: answer-to-answer variance and true decay can't be fully separated.

Sensitivity: with no flicker tolerance, half-lives drop to 10d (URL) and 50d (brand). The gap holds.

Data: SlateIndex, CC BY 4.0. Analysis by Slate research.